ECE 49401: Professional Communication Capstone

Description: The goal of this course is to hone your communication skills and get you ready to launch successful careers and lives. By the end of this course, you should feel much more comfortable articulating and living your values and ethics, creating high-quality work documents, and effectively working your growth plan for the next 3-12 months.

Learning outcomes:
1. Create a collaborative and inclusive environment with our teams.
2. Communicate effectively with professional audiences.
3. Develop a plan for meeting short-term professional and/or personal goals.
4. Demonstrate the ability to make informed ethical judgements in professional contexts

Typical weekly requirements:
~10-15 pages of reading
1-2 pre-lecture videos
1-2 lecture videos
1-2 content quizzes
Discussions and/or Major Assignments

Typical weekly due dates:
Monday: content quizzes
Wednesday: discussion posts
Friday: discussion responses and major assignments

Course grade structure:
Quizzes – 30% of grade
Discussions – 30% of grade
Major Assignments – 40% of grade
Assignments:

Each unit will have its own assignments with clear instructions provided via Brightspace, but you'll find some general guidelines below.

Assignments:
Content quizzes: Each week, you'll have one (or more quizzes) over the content covered. These quizzes aren't meant to trick you; they're meant to check for comprehension and engagement. Sometimes there is an activity you need to complete before the quiz. Be sure to do that.

Discussions: Several times this semester, you will have a discussion prompt to respond to on your group's discussion board. Your group mates will give you feedback and further the discussion to establish a collaborative experience in the course. This will also allow you to

practice giving & receiving feedback regularly and to practice leading & participating in engaging, collaborative discussions on a variety of topics.

Discussion responses: For each discussion, you'll comment extensively at least TWO times in a way that contributes to the discussions and moves them forward. **The exception to this is in the Intro Discussion – you need to respond to ALL groupmates' posts that week.**

Your goals in your responses are to interact, dive deeper, complicate, and resolve. Your goal is not just to agree or disagree. Your goal is to add and enhance. Consider all of the online communication that goes on in workplaces. This is your opportunity to work on the skills you'll need to contribute meaningfully to those conversations and get your ideas heard – while respecting and integrating the ideas of others.

Memo or visual communication assignment (20% of grade): This is a major assignment that will ask you to synthesize multiple weeks of communication information to create and revise your own professional document.

Ethics assignment (20% of your grade): This is a major assignment that will ask you to synthesize multiple weeks of ethics information into a thorough examination of an ethical quandary in your specific sub-field interests.

Grading scheme:

A	B	C	D	F
100-93: A	89-87: B+	79-77: C+	69-67: D+	<60: F
92-90: A-	86-83: B	76-73: C	66-63: D	
	82-80: B-	72-70: C-	62-60: D-	